

Women's fashion

Fashion is the style of what we wear, and how we wear it. The most important thing about Western fashion is that it changes. Hundreds of years ago, styles altered slowly, but now they move on very fast.

1300s

FASHION STARTS HERE

Women wore the same type of clothing for centuries, but by the 1300s fashion started changing more quickly and new dress styles were invented. There were strict laws on what to wear but women found ways to break the rules.



WOOL



MEDIEVAL DRESS

1400–1600s

RICH RENAISSANCE

Beautiful soft new materials, such as silk and velvet, became available to the rich. Skirts became wider, and mix-and-match clothes were popular. Sleeves could be untied and taken off for washing.



VELVET DAY DRESS



ORNATE HANDBAG



OUTDOOR SHOES



COURT DRESS

1940s

THRIFTY FORTIES

During World War II, material was scarce. Women dressed sensibly and learned how to make and recycle their own clothes. They still wanted to look stylish, using colourful accessories to add personality to plain outfits.



WAR ADVERT
To encourage women to make clothes last longer.



EMERALD-GREEN HEELS



HAIR TIED UP, KNEE-LENGTH DRESS

1930s

GLAMOROUS GOWNS

In this decade, fashion was inspired by Hollywood film stars. Long, sleek dresses were designed to create a slender look. Jackets had padded shoulders, which made the waist and hips look narrower.



WHITE SATIN EVENING DRESS



FLORAL DRESS



WIDE-BRIMMED STRAW HAT

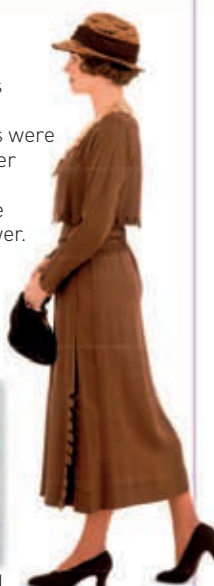


ELEGANT LEATHER GLOVES



DRESS PATTERN

FITTED JACKET AND SKIRT



1950s

THE "NEW LOOK"

Designer Christian Dior created a new way of dressing in the 1950s. The look was very feminine, with a tight waist, swirling skirt, pearl necklaces, and earrings. Gloves and hats were almost always worn when leaving the house.



LONG SUIT DRESS



DAY HANDBAG

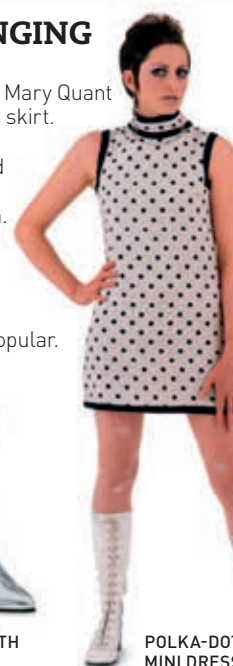


PEEP-TOE HEELS

1960s

THE SWINGING SIXTIES

London designer Mary Quant invented the mini skirt. Hems were the shortest they had ever been in the history of fashion. Shiny fabrics, space-age silver, knee high boots, and lots of eye make-up were popular.



POLKA-DOT MINI DRESS



PLASTIC ZIP-UP JACKET



SILVER BOOTS WITH POINTED TOES



STRIPED SEQUINED MINI